Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, February 27, 2023

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Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower
Regrets:	Regional Councillor	J. Dies

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

Mayor Collier declared a pecuniary interest with respect to a portion of the GGC Budget Report (Item 7.2.1 of the Council Agenda, Item 6.2.1 of the Budget GGC Report), as he has a family member that works in in the Recreation Department. Mayor Collier asked that the recreation portion of the GGC operating budget be separated from the rest of the approvals so that he can refrain from voting.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on January 23, 2023 be adopted.
CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Jason McWilliam, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no questions had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: Durham Black Network Black History Month

Carion Fenn, President, Carion Fenn Foundation & Co-Founder, Durham Black Network, provided an overview of the Durham Black Network organization and delivered a presentation on Black History Month. C. Fenn discussed the mission and vision of Durham Black Network, programming, equity and equality marketing campaign, and opportunities for change and contribution to promoting equity and equality. C. Fenn played a short video in memory of Olga Lambert.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked C. Fenn for her presentation.

5.2 Delegation & Proclamation: Save Soil - Conscious Planet

Kiran Manjunath, Volunteer for Save Soil, delivered a presentation regarding Conscious Planet – Save Soil, a global movement to save soil. K. Manjunath discussed soil significance, soil degradation, solutions, and national policy change.

Council Members asked about local efforts to inspire policy change. K. Manjunath responded to the question.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate to K. Manjunath and proclaimed March 21, 2023 as Save Soil Day in the Town of Ajax.

5.3 **Presentation: Ajax Public Library Bookmark Contest Winners**

Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, presented the 2023 Bookmark Contest Winners via a short video presentation and noted that 109 submissions were received. S. Vaisler thanked Council for the opportunity to recognize the contest participants.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier congratulated the winners.

5.4 **Presentation: Economic Development and Tourism Strategy and Action Plan**

Samuel Twumasi, Manager of Economic Development introduced Simon Gill, Director, Economic Development & Tourism; Invest Durham, Durham Region.

S. Gill delivered a presentation regarding 'Ready Set Future', Durham Region's five-year Economic Development and Tourism Strategy and Action Plan. S. Gill reviewed the acknowledgement and discussed the vision for the Economic Development and Tourism Strategy, economic growth principles, priority clusters, long term aspirations, and five-year goals including 71 action items.

Council Members asked questions regarding activities to support the Agri-Food sector. S. Gill responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked S. Gill for his presentation.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 6.4, 6.5, 6.8, 6.10 and 6.16 for discussion.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.6, 6.7, 6.9, 6.11, 6.12, 6.13, 6.14, 6.15, and 6.17) dated February 27, 2023 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Crawford assumed the Chair.

Item 6.4

Council Members discussed the motion including impacts on the release and development of Greenbelt Lands in the Region of Durham.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Item 6.4 ("The Regional Municipality of Durham – Envision Durham – Release of the draft new Regional Official Plan") of the Correspondence Report be received for information.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

Item 6.5

Council Members expressed support for the motion to provide an extension to the commenting period to at least March 31, 2023.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Item 6.5 ("Municipality of Clarington – Envision Durham Update Information Report: Proposed Growth Allocations and Settlement Area Boundary Expansions") of the

Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.8

Council Members expressed support for the location of the new Lakeridge Health Hospital in Whitby.

Move by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That Item 6.8 ("Town of Whitby – New Lakeridge Health Hospital") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.10

Council Members expressed support for the motion. Council Members inquired about the administration of school board elections namely staff resources, time, and costs. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to the question from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Item 6.10 ("Town of Petrolia – School Board Elections") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.16

Council Members expressed support for the motion noting that the homelessness crisis is a national crisis that requires funding from appropriate levels of government.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That Item 6.16 ("Ontario's Big City Mayors – Health and Homelessness Strategy") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. **Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report**

7.1.1 **Community Affairs & Planning Committee, February 6, 2023**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated February 6, 2023, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2. **General Government Committee Report**

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Crawford assumed the Chair.

7.2.1 **2023 Operating & Capital Budget, February 16, 2023**

Mayor Collier, Budget Chair, provided comments regarding the outcome of the 2023 Operating & Capital Budget and thanked staff for their hard work on the preparation of the 2023 Budget.

Motion 1

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the General Government Committee 2023 Operating & Capital Budget Meeting Report dated February 16, 2023 be adopted, with the exception of the portion of the Budget that deals with the Recreation Programs/Active Living Operating Budget (page 69 of the Operating Budget Document).

CARRIED

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Crawford

Opposed: None

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

Members separated the 'Recreation Programs & Active Living' (page 69) section for the purposes of voting. Mayor Collier abstained from voting on the separated section due to his declared pecuniary interest.

Motion 2

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the portion of the Budget that that deals with the Recreation Programs/Active Living Operating Budget be approved**.**

CARRIED

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

7.2.2 **General Government Committee, February 21, 2023**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the General Government Committee Report dated February 21, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 **Summary of Advisory Committee Activities**

None

7.4 **Departmental Reports**

7.4.1. **FIN-2023-05: 2023 Report on Non-Cash Expenses as Required by Ontario Regulation 284/09**

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the report on Excluded Non-Cash Expenses, as required by Ontario Regulation 284/09, be received for information.

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Council Members provided updates regarding the proposed clear garbage bag pilot program in the Municipality of Clarington noting that a motion was passed to terminate the program, expansions to the green bin program effective July 1, 2023, approval of the Transit Service and Financing Strategy, approval of the Region's Investment Portfolio, and approval of nominations to various Region of Durham committees.

Regional Council Members discussed funding allocations to Durham Region Transit to support transit service enhancements and framework for the Community Safety and Well-Being Plan.

Mayor Collier discussed potential budget cuts to the Durham Regional Police Services Board, next steps, and potential service impacts. Council Members sought clarification regarding which services would be impacted. Mayor Collier responded to the question.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of February 27, 2023 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Crawford assumed the Chair.

9.1 Updating Permitted Use in Employment Zones

Mayor Collier and Regional Councillor Lee introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Council Members asked questions regarding employment area density targets. Mayor Collier responded to the question.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax has a fixed urban boundary and a finite amount of employment lands;

AND WHEREAS self storage facilities, gas stations, and car washes offer very limited employment opportunities, and their development may diminish future opportunities for more job-intensive businesses;

AND WHEREAS the Town's Official Plan and Zoning By-Law focus on land use and regulate how land may be used and which types of buildings are permitted;

AND WHEREAS the Official Plan already dictates that public storage facilities shall not be permitted in the Prestige Employment designation;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

New public storage facilities not be permitted through the OP and Zoning By-Law in any zone;

New motor vehicle gas bars and washing establishments not be permitted through the OP and Zoning By-Law in any zone; and

That staff be directed to initiate the necessary work by April 2023.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

10. By-laws

Members of Council asked questions regarding By-law 05-2023 namely scope of work. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services and S. Twumasi, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 05-2023 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including the holy month of Ramadan beginning March 22, 2023, a virtual community Ward 2 meeting on March 2, 2023, and Live with Mayor Collier on March 28, 2023.

Council Members noted that the Toronto District School Board (TDSB) approved mandatory indigenous education. Council Members acknowledged and congratulated TDSB and Isaiah Shafqat, Indigenous student trustee on the TDSB for supporting the change.

Regional Councillor Crawford noted that she applied to the 2022-2023 AMO Board of Directors and has made it to the top 5.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 06-2023 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on February 27, 2023, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the February 27, 2023 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (8:23 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

_____
D-Clerk